Taking Away Objects and Writing Subtraction Equations Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 3	3. 3	5. 4	7. 7
2. 4	4. 6	6. 5	8. 4

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1
K.OA.A / 1.OA.C.6 / 2.OA.B.2 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8*
Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 8 tagged checks.

Common wrong answers

3. *If they got 5: counted the apples that were crossed out instead of the ones still there*
4. *If they got 14: added the two numbers instead of taking away*
5. *If they got 6: counted every bird in the story and forgot to take any away*

1. 5 counters, cross out 2.

Solution: Start with all 5 counters. Two of them get an X, so those two are gone. Touch and count the counters with no X: 1, 2, 3. Three counters remain, and the equation the picture tells is $5 - 2 = 3$. The number left is $\boxed{3}$.

2. 7 stars, cross out 3.

Solution: Count on the picture: 7 stars to begin with. Cross out 3, and count what is not crossed out: 1, 2, 3, 4. A student may also count back from 7: "6, 5, 4" — three counts back lands on 4. Either route gives $7 - 3 = 4$. The number left is $\boxed{4}$.

3. 8 apples, Ravi takes 5.

Solution: The whole is 8 apples. The part taken away is 5 apples, so 5 of the 8 dots get an X. Counting the dots with no X gives 1, 2, 3. Written as an equation, whole − part taken = part left, so $8 - 5 = 3$. Apples still in the basket: $\boxed{3}$.
Watch for: a child who answers 5 has read the crossed-out group instead of the group that is left.

4. Full ten-frame, cross out 4.

Solution: A full ten-frame is $5 + 5 = 10$ cubes. Crossing out 4 leaves the rest of the frame. Count the uncrossed cubes: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6. So $10 - 4 = 6$ and the number of cubes left is $\boxed{6}$.

5. 6 birds, 2 fly away.

Solution: Draw 6 dots for the birds sitting on the fence. Flying away means taking away, so cross out 2 dots. Four dots have no X. The equation for the story is $6 - 2 = 4$, and the number of birds left on the fence is $\boxed{4}$.

6. 9 blocks, 4 left — how many were given away?

Solution: Here the whole (9) and one part (4 left) are known, and the part given away is missing. Count up from 4 to 9: "5, 6, 7, 8, 9" — that is five counts, so five blocks are missing from the picture. Check by taking away: $9 - 5 = 4$ ✓. Blocks given away: $\boxed{5}$.

7. 10 grapes, 3 left — how many were eaten?

Solution: Whole = 10, part left = 3, part eaten is missing. Count up from 3 to 10: "4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10" — seven counts. Check by taking away: $10 - 7 = 3$ ✓. Grapes eaten: $\boxed{7}$.

8. Challenge — 10 counters, 6 left.

Solution: The ten-frame starts full with 10 counters. Cross out counters one at a time and stop when exactly 6 are uncrossed — that happens after four X's, because the top row of five plus one from the bottom row is 6 uncrossed. Count up from 6 to 10 to confirm: "7, 8, 9, 10" is four counts. The whole story is $10 - 4 = 6$, so the number crossed out is $\boxed{4}$.